

Money, Generosity, and Contentment

Jesus talked about money more than almost anything because money tells the truth about the heart.

Text. Selected texts on money and possessions

Good for. A congregation that owns more than it admits worrying about

The arc. Money is never neutral in Scripture. It is either a rival lord or a servant of love, and this series traces the heart from the idol of more to the freedom of contentment and the joy of open hands.

1. You Cannot Serve Both

Matthew 6:19-24

Big idea. Money makes a claim to be god, and Jesus says plainly that no heart can bow to it and to Him at once.

Aim. To make the hearer name money as a master rather than a tool.

Notes

2. The Rich Fool

Luke 12:13-21

Big idea. A man rich toward his barns and poor toward God dies the night his plan is complete, and his wealth goes to someone else.

Aim. To confront the hearer with the night their accumulation will end.

Notes

3. The Cheerful Giver

2 Corinthians 9:6-15

Big idea. God loves a cheerful giver because giving flows from grace received, and He supplies the seed He calls us to sow.

Aim. To turn the hearer's giving from duty into the overflow of grace.

Notes

4. Godliness With Contentment

1 Timothy 6:6-19

Big idea. The love of money pierces the soul, while godliness with contentment is the great gain that money cannot buy.

Aim. To free the hearer from the lie that more would finally be enough.

Notes

5. He Who Was Rich Became Poor

2 Corinthians 8:1-9

Big idea. Christ became poor to make us rich, and the churches that gave out of deep poverty understood the gift they had received.

Aim. To root the hearer's generosity in the self-giving of Christ Himself.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.